

**2026 PSML Division A Championships
Rule Changes and Important Notes**

1		The starter used to have sole jurisdiction over the starting position; now it is the starter or stroke and turn. (Rule 101.1.2.E). (typically observed in backstroke) * A swimmer shall be disqualified for an illegal starting position at the start if the swimmer moves from a legal starting position to an illegal starting position immediately prior to or after the “take your marks” command provided that the illegal starting position exists when the signal to start the race is given. * In the backstroke, the toes cannot be curled over the gutter (Adelphi has no gutter). Toes may be above the water but not above the pool edge. * If a swimmer’s feet are in a legal starting position and then move to an illegal position and the feet are still illegal at the start, the S&T or starter has jurisdiction to disqualify. * If the swimmer immediately assumes an illegal position, the S&T or starter should instruct the swimmer to correct it. * If the feet are in an illegal position and the swimmer is allowed to continue without correction and the race is started, no DQ will be issued.
2		No Technical Suits shall be worn by any 12 & Under athlete in competition at any sanctioned, approved or observed meet. If the swimmer is 12&U and the suit has a QR code, then look for a green box with a checkmark.
3		Swimmers must remain and finish the race in the same lane in which they started. (Article 102.21.5)
4		Swimmers may be submerged while finishing the butterfly and freestyle. (101.3, 101.4, 101.5) * Once some part of the head of the swimmer has passed the final 5-meter mark, immediately prior to reaching for the finish, the swimmer may be completely submerged. * Must conform to the stroke rules. For example, in backstroke when the swimmer resubmerges to reach for the wall, they may not take a stroke as it is no longer "reaching" (101.4.2, Situations and Resolutions 2025-03-07 #68).
5		Therapeutic elastic tape is no longer prohibited. Buddy taping is limited to two fingers and/or two toes.
6		(PMSL) Towels may be used for backstroke starts only (no forward starts or relay exchanges), one single one layer towel, must be removed after the start (no penalty for not removing), and may not interfere with other swimmers or officials.